Kids Travel Packing Checklist

Free printable. Keep the age groups you need, cross out the rest.

Trip _____ Leaving on _____

Everyone

- [ ] Passport (in the adult's bag)
- [ ] Comfort item / lovey
- [ ] Refillable water bottle (empty through security)
- [ ] Snacks for travel day
- [ ] Headphones (kid-size)
- [ ] Tablet / books / small activities
- [ ] Sunscreen
- [ ] Medicine (fever / pain, as your pediatrician advises)
- [ ] Any prescriptions + copy of the prescription
- [ ] Band-aids and wipes
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Kids (5-12)

- [ ] Booster seat (or confirm the rental has one)
- [ ] Small backpack they carry themselves
- [ ] Travel journal + pencils
- [ ] Card game / travel game
- [ ] Kid's own copy of the itinerary
- [ ] Reading book for the plane
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Baby (0-12 mo)

- [ ] Diapers (1 per hour of travel + extras)
- [ ] Wipes and changing pad
- [ ] Formula / bottles / breast-pump parts
- [ ] Baby food and spoons
- [ ] Pacifiers + clip
- [ ] Car seat (or confirm the rental has one)
- [ ] Stroller or baby carrier
- [ ] Burp cloths
- [ ] Travel crib sheet
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Toddler / preschool (1-4)

- [ ] Diapers or pull-ups + spares
- [ ] Sippy cup
- [ ] Travel stroller
- [ ] Portable potty seat
- [ ] Car seat (or confirm the rental has one)
- [ ] Sticker books / crayons
- [ ] Night light
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Kids' Clothes

Per child, for changeable, wet, cool weather (UK and Ireland). 2 weeks assumes one wash.

Clothes	Weekend	1 week	2 weeks	Packed	Why
Tops	3	5	6	☐	Quick-dry or merino beats cotton
Trousers or leggings	2	3	4	☐	Leggings and joggers dry faster than jeans
Base layers (thermal top + leggings)	1 set	2 sets	2 sets	☐	Cold days, evenings, hill walks
Fleece or warm mid layer	1	1	2	☐	Worn most days under the jacket
Waterproof jacket with a hood	1	1	1	☐	A real waterproof, not showerproof
Waterproof trousers or a puddle suit	1	1	1	☐	Puddle suit (all-in-one) for toddlers
Warm hat	1	1	1	☐	Plus gloves or mittens Oct-Apr
Sun hat	1	1	1	☐	A cool breeze hides how strong the sun is
Pyjamas	1	2	2	☐	One warm pair: old houses get chilly
Socks (wool or merino)	4	8	8	☐	One spare pair a day: feet get wet
Underwear	4	8	8	☐	A couple extra for little ones
Wellies or waterproof shoes	1 pair	1 pair	1 pair	☐	Wellies for small kids
Comfy trainers	1 pair	1 pair	1 pair	☐	Travel days, cities, when wellies are wet
Swimwear	1	1	2	☐	Pools save a wet afternoon
A nicer outfit	1	1	1	☐	Special dinner, afternoon tea, photos
Spare outfit in the carry-on	1	1	1	☐	Full change per child (2 for under-3s)

Extra for babies and toddlers

- ☐ Sleep sack (2 for a baby, in case of leaks)
- ☐ Extra changes: 2 outfits a day (baby), 1 spare a day (toddler)
- ☐ Extra vests / bodysuits
- ☐ Bibs: 2-3 a day, or wipe-clean ones
- ☐ Warm all-in-one or fleece suit for the stroller or carrier

Sleep sack: check the tog guide on the label against the room temperature. Bibs rinse in the sink.

Pack each child's clothes in their own packing cube, with travel-day clothes and the spare outfit on top.

The Plane & Car Bag

Everything within arm's reach for the travel day itself.

Within reach

- [ ] Snacks (more than you think)
- [ ] Refillable water bottle / sippy cup
- [ ] Wipes + small bags
- [ ] Change of clothes for each kid
- [ ] Spare top for you
- [ ] Pacifier / comfort toy
- [ ] Headphones (kid-size)
- [ ] _____

Documents

- [ ] Passports for everyone
- [ ] Birth certificate copies
- [ ] Consent letter if one parent isn't traveling
- [ ] Boarding passes / booking emails
- [ ] _____

Keep them busy

- [ ] Downloaded shows + games
- [ ] Sticker book / coloring
- [ ] Small new toy to unwrap
- [ ] Window clings / magnets
- [ ] Book or audiobook
- [ ] _____

Health

- [ ] Any medicines + dosing syringe
- [ ] Fever reducer for kids
- [ ] Plasters / band-aids
- [ ] Hand sanitizer
- [ ] Motion sickness bands
- [ ] _____

Want the rest of the trip sorted too?

The Family Travel with Kids Planner (Google Sheets & Excel) adds a documents checker, jet-lag plan, day pacing and budget.
darklighthousesolutions.com/travel/planners/